

JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Accomplished Staff Software Engineer with 10 years of experience designing and delivering scalable distributed systems. Proven track record of leading technical initiatives, mentoring engineering teams, and driving architectural improvements across complex microservices environments. Strong expertise in cloud-native development, system design, and modern DevOps practices. Passionate about building high-performance applications and establishing best practices within engineering organisations.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer

Synapse Data Ltd

synapsedataltd.io

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Architected and led the design of a real-time event processing platform handling 500k+ events per second, reducing latency by 60% through optimised stream processing pipelines and improved data structures.

Mentored a team of 6 junior and mid-level engineers, conducting code reviews, technical interviews, and providing career development guidance resulting in 3 internal promotions.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and observability infrastructure using Prometheus, Grafana, and distributed tracing, reducing MTTR by 45% and improving production incident response times.

Drove migration of legacy monolithic application to Kubernetes-based microservices, improving deployment frequency from monthly to daily releases and reducing infrastructure costs by 35%.

Senior Software Engineer

Sainsbury's plc

www.sainsburys.co.uk

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

July 2018 - February 2022

Designed and built a high-throughput order processing system serving 2 million daily transactions using Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, and AWS Lambda, achieving 99.95% uptime SLA.

Led technical design discussions and RFC processes for major architectural decisions, influencing adoption of event-driven architecture across the engineering division.

Optimised critical database queries and implemented caching strategies that reduced API response times by 70% and significantly improved customer-facing application performance.

Established and maintained CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitLab CI, enabling automated testing and deployment processes that reduced mean time to deployment from 4 hours to 15 minutes.

Software Engineer

CloudPeak Technologies Ltd

cloudpeaktech.co

Glasgow, United Kingdom

August 2014 - June 2018

Developed and maintained backend services for a content delivery platform using Java, Spring Framework, and MongoDB, serving 50+ million monthly users globally.

Collaborated with product and UX teams to implement features including user authentication, content recommendation engine, and analytics pipeline used to inform product decisions.

Improved system reliability through comprehensive unit and integration testing, achieving 85% code coverage and reducing production bugs by 40%.

Participated in on-call rotation and debugged complex production issues, implementing permanent fixes and creating runbooks to prevent recurrence of critical incidents.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

September 2012 - August 2014

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

September 2008 - June 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and Frameworks: Java, Python, Go, Spring Boot, Spring Cloud, Django

Cloud and DevOps: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Jenkins, GitLab CI, CloudFormation

Databases and Data: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Cassandra, Redis, Apache Kafka, Elasticsearch

System Design: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, Distributed Systems, Load Balancing, Caching Strategies

Tools and Platforms: Git, Linux, Grafana, Prometheus, DataDog, JIRA, Confluence

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Pair Programming, Code Review, Technical Documentation

CERTIFICATIONS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate, Amazon Web Services, 2021

Kubernetes Application Developer Certified, Linux Foundation, 2020